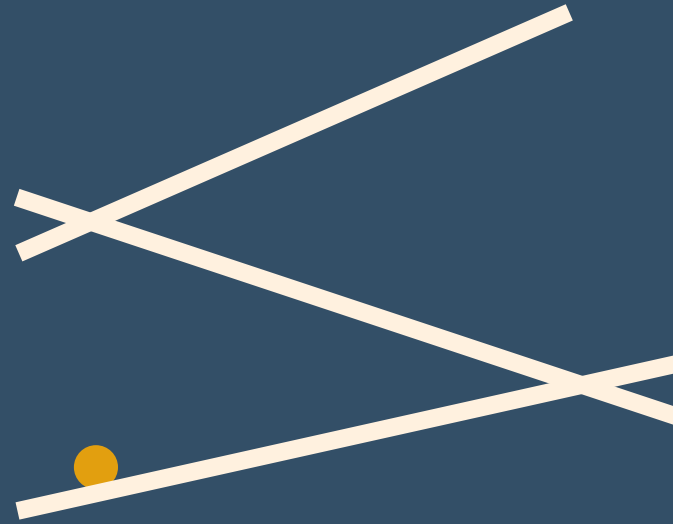




THE GREAT BRISTOL BALL RUN

Bringing interactive STEM play
into the heart of Bristol



A NEW WAY TO EXPERIENCE MILLENNIUM SQUARE.

This proposal outlines an opportunity for We The Curious to host a Ball Run pop-up experience across Millennium Square during the Summer Holidays 2026. The installation would transform the square into a vibrant, interactive destination where families can play, explore and engage with hands-on STEM experiences in a highly visible public setting.

The project would combine:

- › Large-scale interactive ball runs
- › Playful engineering and physics-based learning
- › Family engagement and repeat visitation
- › Increased summer footfall and dwell time
- › Strong social media visibility
- › Revenue generation through branded wooden ball sales
- › The installation would position We The Curious at the centre of one of Bristol's most engaging family-friendly summer activities.

WHAT IS A BALL RUN?

- › Interactive installations where wooden balls travel through wooden and metal channels, obstacles and mechanical features.
- › Part sculpture, part play experience, part social attraction — Ball Runs transform ordinary public spaces into memorable shared experiences.
- › Designed for all the family, they encourage participation, curiosity, movement and repeat interaction.



WHY BALL RUNS WORK SO WELL.

Ball Runs are highly engaging because they combine:

- › Movement
- › Engineering
- › Play
- › Curiosity
- › Competition
- › Problem solving
- › Cause and effect
- › Multi-generational interaction

People are naturally drawn to kinetic movement and interactive experiences and want to engage.

The installations become both an attraction and a social experience.



PROVEN SUCCESS.

Ball Runs have already demonstrated their ability to increase engagement, footfall and secondary spend at leading rural visitor attractions as well as generating significant income through the sale of wooden balls.

Ball Runs are hugely popular in Switzerland and other European countries.

Our sister company has recently brought them into a number of visitor attractions in the UK including The Eden Project and Forestry Commission sites.

Alice Holts, a royal forest in Hampshire, has seen 12% of visitors purchasing balls and has sold over 40,000 sustainable wooden balls in less than 12 months. They have also seen a 15% uplift in visitor numbers since installing ball runs.



THE CONCEPT:

THE GREAT BRISTOL BALL RUN.

We propose installing 6–7 Ball Runs throughout Millennium Square, alongside additional smaller installations in surrounding locations linked to the square.

Each installation would feature unique movement, sound, engineering and play mechanics designed to encourage curiosity, experimentation and repeat interaction.

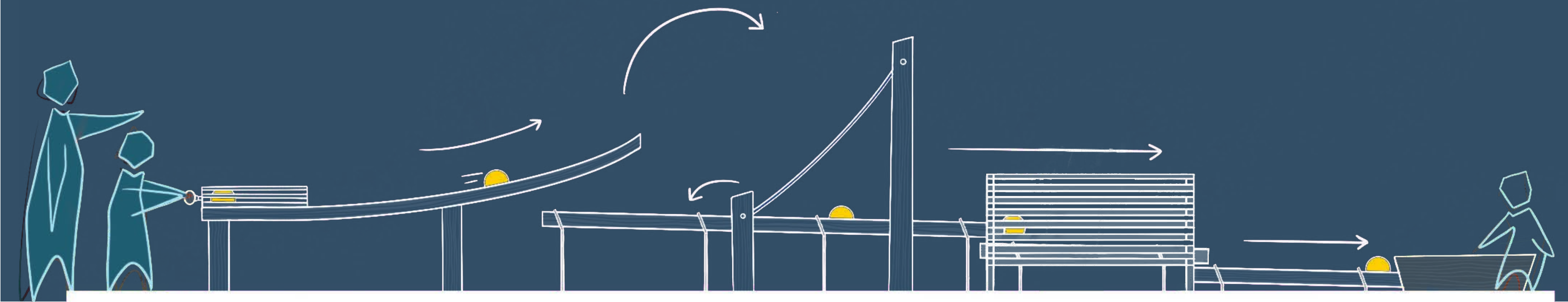
The result would be a highly visible STEM-focused public experience aligned with the mission and identity of We The Curious.

*Summer
2026*

The installations would create an interactive urban trail encouraging families and visitors to:

- › Explore the wider area
- › Spend longer in the city centre
- › Repeatedly engage with the installations
- › Enter We The Curious to purchase sustainable, branded wooden balls
- › Share their experiences on social media

WHY THIS WORKS PERFECTLY FOR WE THE CURIOUS



CURIOSITY IN MOTION.

A Ball Run activation strongly aligns with the mission of We The Curious by transforming STEM learning into a large-scale, hands-on public experience.

The installation would:

- > Bring people into We The Curious but extend the experience beyond the building itself**
- > Bring playful engineering and physics into a public setting**
- > Increase visibility and awareness across the city centre**
- > Create new reasons for families to visit during the summer holidays**
- > Encourage repeat engagement throughout the holiday period**
- > Strengthen We The Curious' reputation as an innovative and interactive destination**

The installations would naturally demonstrate:

- › Gravity
- › Momentum
- › Speed
- › Friction
- › Sound
- › Mechanical systems
- › Problem solving
- › Experimentation

All through intuitive, playful interaction.



A photograph of Millennium Square in London at dusk. In the foreground, a large, dark, rectangular fountain structure with water cascading down is visible. In the background, the iconic glass dome of the Royal Albert Hall is illuminated against a twilight sky. The square is wet, reflecting the lights, and a few people can be seen walking in the distance.

**WHY
MILLENNIUM
SQUARE IS
THE IDEAL
LOCATION**

WHERE THE CITY COMES TO PLAY.

Millennium Square already attracts large numbers of families, visitors and city centre footfall.

A Ball Run installation would help transform the space into a destination experience during Summer 2026.

Benefits of the location include:

- › High visibility within Bristol city centre
- › Strong existing family footfall
- › Open public space ideal for large-scale installations

- › Excellent proximity to We The Curious
- › The Ball Run naturally complements the iconic silver Planetarium sphere, creating a playful visual connection between movement, gravity, physics and exploration.
- › Opportunities for linked experiences and trails
- › Strong event and festival atmosphere during summer months
- › Excellent social media and photographic potential

The installation would create a vibrant, animated public environment that encourages visitors to stop, play and spend time in the area.

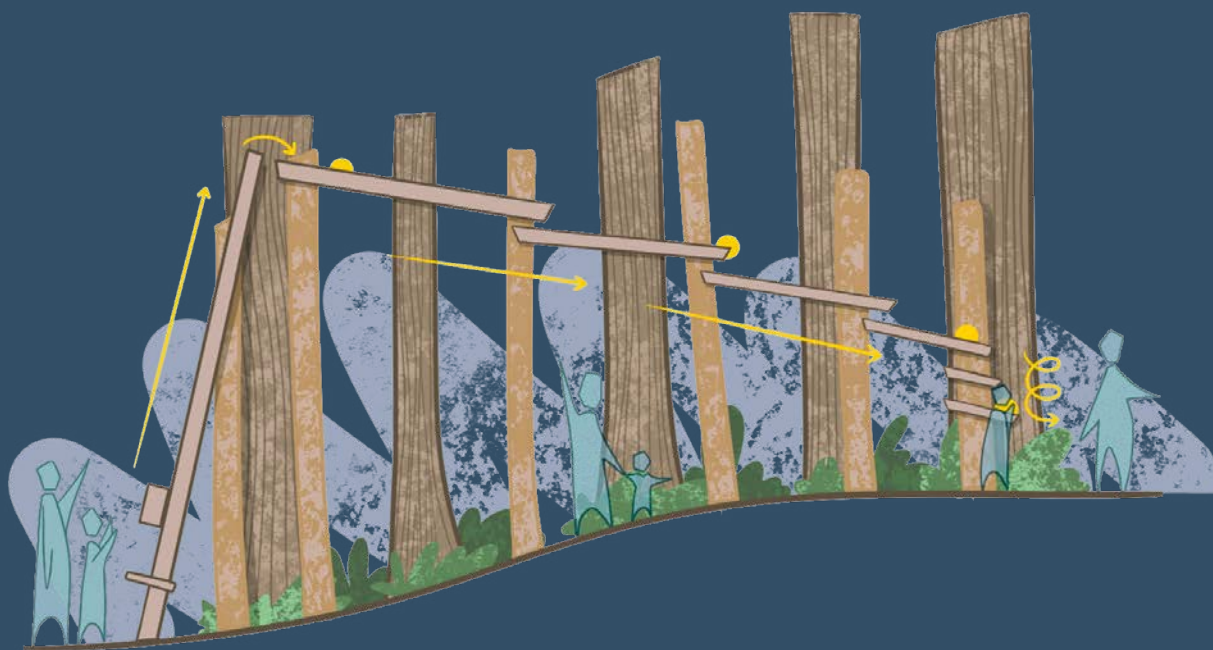
BENEFITS FOR WE THE CURIOUS



SOCIAL MEDIA & CITY-WIDE VISIBILITY.

Kinetic installations perform exceptionally well across platforms such as TikTok, Instagram and YouTube.

The installation would create a highly photogenic and memorable public experience strongly associated with the venue.



A Ball Run activation in Millennium Square would encourage:

- High levels of user-generated content
- Organic online promotion
- Increased destination awareness
- Family photo and video sharing
- Great video content to share on big screens in Millennium Square and other channels
- Press and media interest
- A strong summer visual identity for We The Curious
- Helping to deliver your mission of connecting and empowering people through sharing creative experiences



REVENUE OPPORTUNITY BRANDED WOODEN BALLS.

The wooden balls are central to the experience.

Visitors purchase branded wooden balls which can then be reused throughout the installations.

The sale of branded balls creates a direct revenue opportunity throughout the duration of the activation.

The balls become:

- › Part activity
- › Part souvenir
- › Part collectible item
- › Part marketing tool

Branded balls encourage:

- › Repeat play
- › Repeat purchases
- › Lasting connection with the experience
- › Increased visitor participation

WIDER BENEFITS



STEM LEARNING THROUGH PLAY.

The installations create accessible, organic, hands-on STEM experiences that visitors of all ages can instantly understand and enjoy.

The ball runs can support:

- › Informal science learning
- › Educational storytelling
- › School holiday programming
- › Workshops and demonstrations
- › Family engagement activities
- › Engineering and physics themes

The experience combines entertainment and learning in a format that is highly repeatable and widely accessible.



PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL.

To support delivery of the project, Ball Run will cover the initial construction and installation costs of the Ball Runs, and will provide ongoing maintenance and repair of all structures throughout the summer — including any damage caused by vandalism.

The Ball Runs will be designed and positioned to ensure minimal impact on We The Curious's existing event hire opportunities within the square.

Branded wooden balls will be delivered and replenished by Ball Run as stock sells through.

In return, we would seek a commitment from We The Curious to:

- › Purchase an agreed volume of branded wooden balls for Summer 2026
- › Promote the activation through their own marketing channels

This approach allows:

- › A fully funded installation at no cost to We The Curious
- › Shared investment in the success of the activation
- › A sustainable revenue model for the project
- › Strong alignment between visitor engagement and commercial return

The greater the public engagement, the greater the opportunity for ball sales and repeat participation.

A close-up photograph of a wooden ball run structure. A light-colored wooden ball is positioned in the center of a wooden track. The track is supported by a vertical wooden post. The background is blurred, showing more of the structure and some greenery.

A DESTINATION EXPERIENCE FOR SUMMER 2026.

The Great Bristol Ball Run has the potential to become one of Bristol's most memorable family-friendly summer experiences.

By combining:

- › STEM learning
- › Interactive play
- › Public engagement
- › Social sharing
- › Urban placemaking
- › Commercial opportunity

The activation would create a highly visible and distinctive experience in the heart of the city.

This is an opportunity to transform Millennium Square into a playful, educational and highly shareable destination throughout the school summer holidays.

BEYOND 2026 **A LONG-TERM** **PARTNERSHIP** **OPPORTUNITY.**

The Great Bristol Ball Run pop-up could become the first step towards a permanent network of Giant Ball Runs across Bristol from 2027 onwards.

The Summer 2026 activation would:

- Build public awareness and excitement
- Test engagement and visitor behaviour
- Generate social media visibility and press coverage
- Demonstrate the educational and commercial potential of the concept within the city

By becoming an early partner, We The Curious would help shape the future of the project while positioning itself at the centre of one of Bristol's most distinctive new public STEM experiences.



**FROM TEMPORARY
SUMMER ACTIVATION
TO PERMANENT CITY-
WIDE EXPERIENCE...**

NEXT STEPS.

We would welcome the opportunity to discuss:

- › Potential layouts and installation concepts
- › Visitor flow and placement strategy
- › Ball branding and retail opportunities
- › Programming and educational integration
- › Installation timelines for Summer 2026
- › Partnership structure and commercial model





THANK YOU.

ANY QUESTIONS?

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